

Nicolas Bau

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EDUCATION

University of Geneva

Switzerland

Ph.D. Candidate in Political Science

2022 –

Dissertation: “*The Political Economy of National Development Finance Institutions*”

Advisor: *Simone Dietrich*

Princeton University

USA

Visiting Student Research Collaborator, Department of Politics

2025 – 2026

Sponsor: *Layna Mosley*

Sciences Po Paris

France

M.A. in Political Science

2020 – 2022

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

4. Bau, Nicolas, Simone Dietrich, Jing Qian, and Duy Trinh. The Institutional Politics of Development Finance: ODA's Role in Shaping Subnational DFI Investments. With Simone Dietrich, Jing Qian, and Duy Trinh. Conditionally accepted, *The Review of International Organizations*.
3. Bau, Nicolas, Simone Dietrich, Katharina Fleiner, and Alice Iannantuoni. Populism and the Politics of Aid Classification: Evidence from the OECD DAC. Forthcoming, *International Studies Quarterly*.
2. Bau, Nicolas, Simone Dietrich, Katharina Fleiner, and Alice Iannantuoni. 2025. Examining New Donors in the OECD's Development Assistance Committee. *Journal of International Development*.
1. Bau, Nicolas. 2025. Compte-rendu de “Chiapello, E., et al. (2023). Financializations of Development. Global Games and Local Experiments. Routledge”. *Gouvernement et action publique*.

WORKING PAPERS

3. What Geopolitical Returns Does Official Development Assistance Bring?. With Simone Dietrich. *Kiel Working Paper* (2025). *Global Nation Briefing* (2026). Covered in *Der Spiegel*.
2. Financing the Global Gateway: How a Reconfigured EU Development Architecture Elevated National Development Finance Institutions. With Simone Dietrich.
Revise and resubmit at the *Journal of European Integration* for Special Issue on the Global Gateway, edited by Eugénia da Conceição-Heldt and Sophie Meunier.
1. Measuring Debt Transparency in Developing Countries: An IRT Approach. With Zoe Ge, Layna Mosley, and B. Peter Rosendorff.
PSFL Policy Brief 25-3 (2025).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

6. Private Capital Mobilization in Infrastructure Development: The Role of Bilateral Development Finance Institutions. With Simone Dietrich, Jihye Park, and Jing Qian.
5. Lobbying for Development: How Firms Shape Investment Decisions within the U.S. Development Finance Corporation. With Simone Dietrich and Jihye Park.
4. Small Donors and the World Bank's IFC: Explaining Co-Financing in Development. With Tetsekela Anyiam-Osigwe.
3. Compete or Coordinate? The Politics of Investment Pooling in Development Finance.
2. The Marketization of Foreign Aid.
1. Sustainability Risk Mitigation in International Development Finance.

POLICY WRITINGS

3. Ngom, Fatoumata, Nicolas Bau, and Valérie Gaveau. 2025. Assessing the additionality of Development Finance Institutions: frameworks, challenges, guidance. OECD DAC Working Party on Development Finance Statistics.
2. Delalande, Guillaume, Nicolas Bau, and Valérie Gaveau. 2024. Stocktake and Revised Methodology on the Peer Reviews on Development Finance Statistics. OECD DAC Working Party on Development Finance Statistics.
1. Hos, Tomáš, Nicolas Bau, and Valérie Gaveau. 2024. Report on the ODA-Eligibility of Private Sector Instruments Extended in Developing Countries. OECD Development Assistance Committee.

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCES

American Political Science Association (APSA)	2026 (<i>scheduled</i>)
European Political Science Society (EPSS)	2026 (<i>scheduled</i>)
International Political Economy Society (IPES)	2025
International Studies Association (ISA)	2026
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2026
The Political Economy of International Organization (PEIO)	2025, 2026
Swiss Political Science Association (SVPW-ASSP)	2026

WORKSHOPS AND EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS

2026: Development Banking Research Conference: Public Banks in a Changing Global Financial Architecture (French Development Agency), Workshop on Infrastructures in International Relations (University of Hong Kong), University of International Business and Economics (Beijing), Shanghai Institutes for International Studies (Shanghai), Workshop on Development Finance and Global Economic Governance (NYU Shanghai), Aix-Marseille University (Aix-en-Provence).

2025: The Geocoded Official Development Assistance Dataset (GODAD) Workshop (University of Göttingen), Workshop on Mutual Interests in ODA with Gates Foundation and GlobalNation (Kiel Institute), The Future of Development Assistance Workshop (invited, declined) (University of Pittsburgh), The Political Economy of Aid and International Organizations Workshop (University of Milan-Bicocca), Reimagining Development Assistance Workshop (University of Pittsburgh).

2024: European Union's Global Gateway Workshop I (Princeton University), European Union's Global Gateway Workshop II (Technical University of Munich).

TEACHING

Instructor-of-record

Political Economy of Foreign Aid (UG, average evaluation: 3.8/4)	<i>Fall 2022, 2023; Spring 2025</i>
International Development Organizations (UG, not assessed)	<i>Spring 2023, 2024</i>
Bachelor Thesis Seminar (UG, average evaluation: 4/4)	<i>AY 2022, 2023</i>

Guest lectures at graduate level

Sciences Po's School of Public Affairs, invited by Prof. Matthias Thiemann	<i>Fall 2024</i>
EHESS Paris, invited by Prof. Liora Israël	<i>Spring 2020</i>

SUPERVISION

Supervision of 26 BA theses in International Relations	<i>2022-24</i>
Proposed for peer-reviewed publication: Florian Guery (2024)	
Recipient of the Prize for Best Undergraduate Thesis in Political Science: Vera Rüegg (2024), Mariana Hervigo (nominee, 2023)	

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Discipline

Panel Co-Organizer: APSA 2026, Firm-Level Preferences in Climate and Development Finance
Panel Chair: ISA 2026
Section Co-Chair, International Affairs Section, Swiss Political Science Association
Reviewer for *Comparative Political Studies*, *Revue Internationale des Études du Développement*.

Department

Co-Organizer, Master-Class on Process-Tracing Within Multi-Methods Design, Geneva	<i>2024</i>
Member, Search Committee for a Lecturer in International Relations, University of Geneva	<i>2023</i>
Member, Gender Equality Commission of the Global Studies Institute, University of Geneva	<i>2023-24</i>
Co-Convenor, Graduate and Post-Doctoral Research Seminar in Politics, University of Geneva	<i>2022-25</i>

Mentoring

Mentor, Graduate Applications International Network (GAIN)	<i>2025-26</i>
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GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Travel Grant, APSA International Collaboration Section (USD 500)	<i>2026</i>
Travel Grant, Academic Society of Geneva (CHF 1,900)	<i>2026</i>
Doctoral Mobility Scholarship, Swiss National Science Foundation (CHF 19,480)	<i>2025</i>
Faculty of Social Sciences Grant, University of Geneva (CHF 2,550)	<i>2025</i>
Research Grant, Ernst and Lucie Schmidheiny Foundation (CHF 6,500)	<i>2024</i>
Dissertation Grant, Swiss National Science Foundation	<i>2024</i>
Department Travel Grants, University of Geneva (CHF 2,000)	<i>2024, 2025</i>
Travel Grants, Geneva Global Studies Institute (CHF 2,000)	<i>2022, 2023, 2024</i>

Travel Grant, MethodsNET (EUR 1,600)	2023
Full Scholarship, Sciences Po	2020-22

AFFILIATIONS

Princeton Sovereign Finance Lab, Graduate Affiliate	Since 2024
Geneva Africa Lab, Graduate Affiliate	Since 2023

SKILLS

Software: R, Microsoft Office, L^AT_EX, CapitalIQ, Orbis, Refinitiv.
Languages: French (native), English (advanced), Spanish (intermediate).

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, United Kingdom <i>Mathematics for Social Sciences; Advanced Methods for Time Series and Panel Data</i>	2025
MethodsNET, Warsaw, Poland <i>Workshop on Generalized Linear Models</i>	2023
University of Geneva, Relevant coursework in Quantitative Methods <i>Applied Methods for Social Sciences; Longitudinal Analysis; Advanced Quantitative Methods; Causal Inference</i>	2022-2023

OTHER RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Kiel Institute for the World Economy International Development Research Center <i>Consultant on a Gates Foundation-funded project on Mutual Interests in ODA</i>	Berlin, Germany Apr – Jul 2025
OECD Development Co-operation Directorate, Financing for Sustainable Development Division <i>Consultant</i> <i>PhD Trainee</i>	Paris, France Nov 2024 – Mar 2025 Apr – Oct 2024
Sciences Po Center for European Studies and Comparative Politics <i>Full time research assistant for Prof. Philippe Bezès</i>	Paris, France Jul – Aug 2021
Ecole normale supérieure – PSL Maurice Halbwachs Center <i>Full time research assistant for Prof. Liora Israël</i>	Paris, France Jan – Mar 2020
French National Assembly Commission for Sustainable Development and Territorial Planning <i>Summer Parliamentary Intern</i>	Paris, France Jun – Jul 2018